honestly did what was right for the economy? Or will the verdict be less favourable?' ('The man who dared to disagree', *Business Today*, 4 September 2013)

'Subbarao has been in charge at a very difficult time, with global instability as well as growing domestic and economic problems. Our view is that his record has been a mixed one and has to be understood against the complicated times in which he was managing the monetary affairs of the nation.' ('Subbarao's mixed record at RBI', *Mint*, 4 September 2103)

'He bequeaths a good tradition to his successor. The RBI and the country have been well served by this scholarly, thoughtful, modest and dignified man. Posterity will be kinder to him.' ('Subbarao—End of a turbulent tenure', *The Hindu BusinessLine*, 3 September 2013)

Change of Guard

Real-life events do not respect leadership transitions. The last couple of months of my tenure went completely off script. I thought this would be the time when I would travel around and visit many of the Reserve Bank's regional offices and also meet the staff of the central office departments to reminisce and rejoice over our time together. I particularly wanted to reach out to middle- and junior-level professionals of the Reserve Bank whose ideas, insights and perspectives influenced me more than they realized. In the event, I was so fully preoccupied with the rupee tantrums that my last day in office, 4 September 2013, seemed to have arrived almost as abruptly as my first day as governor.

At eleven that morning, I spoke to the entire Reserve Bank staff across the country via a video link-up and told them that I would carry many, many pleasant memories of my association with the Reserve Bank. The challenges and anxieties we went through together and the joy and fun we had together would be enduring memories. I pointed out that in a full-length feature article on the Reserve Bank in 2012, *the Economist* had said: 'The RBI is a role model for the kind of full service central bank that is back in fashion world wide.'[1] I hoped, I added, that in a few years' time from then,